U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs

INFORMATION AND INSTRUCTIONS TO HELP YOU COMPLETE THE AUTHORIZATION TO DISCLOSE PERSONAL INFORMATION TO A THIRD PARTY

GENERAL INFORMATION

At VA, we recognize and respect the importance of privacy. Personal information that we collect is kept confidential to the extent provided by law. In accordance with the Privacy Act and applicable confidentiality statutes, VA will only disclose the information in its custody or control in the following circumstances: where the individual identifies the particular information and consents to its use; where disclosure of the information is required by law; or where the disclosure is otherwise legally permitted, including release for a purpose compatible with the purpose for which it was collected.

By law, VA must have your written permission (an "authorization") to use or give out your claim or benefit information for any purpose that is not permitted by all applicable legal authorities. You may revoke your written permission at any time, except if VA has already acted based on your permission.

QUESTIONS	SPECIFIC INSTRUCTIONS
1-5	In this section, give us the veteran's identification information to include name, social security number, VA file number, date of birth and the veteran's service number, if applicable.
6-9	In this section, provide the beneficiary/claimant's identification information, who ***is not*** the veteran.
10-13	In Item 10 VA will give your personal benefit or claim information to the person or organization you enter in this box. You may select only ***one person*** or ***one organization***. If you designate an organization, you must also identify one or more individuals in that organization to whom VA may disclose your benefit or claim information. This form ***cannot*** be used to disclose federal tax information to third parties. **IMPORTANT:** The information provided in Item 6, "Name of Beneficiary/Claimant Who Is Not the Veteran," ***cannot*** be the same information provided in Item 10. Item 13 tells VA the duration of your consent. If you do not want your authorization to be effective indefinitely, tell us when to stop releasing your personal benefit or claim information to your authorized third party in Item 13. Check the box that applies and fill in dates, if applicable.
14	Select the security question you would like us to ask your designated third party and provide the answer. This question will be asked each time your designated third party contacts the VA.

WHERE DO I SEND MY COMPLETED WORK?

Send your signed authorization in by utilizing the following methods:

MAIL TO	SUBMIT ONLINE
Department of Veterans Affairs **Evidence Intake Center** **PO Box 4444** **Janesville, WI 53547-4444**	**VA gov: www.va.gov** **Direct Upload via access.va.gov**

NOTE: You should make a copy of your signed authorization for your records before mailing it to VA. You can only have one VA Form 21-0845, *Authorization to Disclose Personal Information to a Third Party*, on file with VA at a time.

WHAT IF I CHANGE MY MIND?

If you change your mind and do not want VA to give out your personal benefit or claim information, you may notify us in writing, or by telephone at 1-800-827-1000 or contact VA online at ASK VA: https://ask.va.gov. Upon notification from you VA will no longer give out benefit or claim information (except for the information VA has already given out based on your permission).

OMB Approved No. 2900-0736
Respondent Burden: 5 minutes
Expiration Date: 05/31/2029

VA | U.S. Department of Veterans Affairs

VA DATE STAMP
(DO NOT WRITE IN THIS SPACE)

AUTHORIZATION TO DISCLOSE PERSONAL INFORMATION TO A THIRD PARTY

INSTRUCTIONS: Use this form if you want to give the Department of Veterans Affairs (VA) permission to release your personal beneficiary or claim information to a third party. This form ***may not be executed*** by any beneficiary recognized as incompetent for VA purposes, nor can VA ***accept*** this form from any beneficiary recognized as incompetent for VA purposes.

SECTION I - VETERAN'S IDENTIFICATION INFORMATION

NOTE: You may ***either*** complete the form online or by hand. If completed by hand print the information requested in ink, neatly, and legibly to expedite processing the form.

1. VETERAN'S NAME *(First, Middle Initial, Last)*

2. VETERAN'S SOCIAL SECURITY NUMBER — —

3. VA FILE NUMBER *(If known)*

4. VETERAN'S DATE OF BIRTH *(MM/DD/YYYY)* — —

5. VETERAN'S SERVICE NUMBER *(If applicable)*

SECTION II - BENEFICIARY/CLAIMANT'S IDENTIFICATION INFORMATION

6. NAME OF BENEFICIARY/CLAIMANT WHO IS ***NOT*** THE VETERAN *(First, Middle Initial, Last)*

7. ADDRESS OF BENEFICIARY/CLAIMANT *(Number and Street or rural route, P.O. Box, City, State, ZIP Code and Country)*

8. TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* — —
Enter International Phone Number *(If applicable)* _____

9. EMAIL ADDRESS *(Optional)* ☐ I agree to receive electronic correspondence from VA in regards to my claim.

SECTION III - CONTACT INFORMATION

10. VA IS AUTHORIZED TO DISCLOSE THE INFORMATION SPECIFIED BELOW TO ONE PERSON ***OR*** ONE ORGANIZATION LISTED BELOW. PROVIDE THE NAME AND ADDRESS OF THE PERSON YOU HAVE CHOSEN TO RECEIVE INFORMATION FROM VA IN ITEMS 10A AND 10B ***OR*** PROVIDE THE NAME AND ADDRESS OF THE ORGANIZATION YOU HAVE CHOSEN AND THE NAME OF THE ORGANIZATION'S REPRESENTATIVE IN ITEMS 10C AND 10D.

A. NAME OF PERSON *(First, Middle Initial, Last Name)*

B. ADDRESS OF PERSON

NOTE: An organization may have more than one representative. Include the first and last name of any additional representatives.

C. NAME OF ORGANIZATION *(Include name of representative(s))*

D. ADDRESS OF ORGANIZATION

VETERAN'S SSN ☐☐☐ – ☐☐ – ☐☐☐☐

11. I, THE VETERAN/BENEFICIARY/CLAIMANT AUTHORIZE VA TO CONTACT THE PERSON ***OR*** ORGANIZATION LISTED IN ITEM 10A OR 10C FOR THE PURPOSE OF PROVIDING THE FOLLOWING INFORMATION PERTAINING TO MY VA RECORD *(Check only one box below to tell VA the specific benefit or claim information you want disclosed)*

☐ LIMITED INFORMATION *(Go to Item 12)* ☐ ANY INFORMATION *(Go to Item 13)*

12. IF YOU SELECTED "LIMITED INFORMATION", CHECK ALL THAT APPLY:

☐ Status of pending claim or appeal ☐ Amount of money owed VA ☐ Current benefit and rate

☐ Request a benefit payment letter ☐ Payment history ☐ Change of address or direct deposit

☐ Other *(Specify below):*

13. IF YOU SELECTED "ANY INFORMATION", THE TERMS OF SUCH RELEASE OF INFORMATION WILL BE:

☐ One time only ☐ Ongoing until written notice is given to VA to terminate

☐ From the date of signing below until *(Specify Date (MM/DD/YYYY)):* ☐☐ – ☐☐ – ☐☐☐☐

14. SPECIFY THE SECURITY QUESTION YOU WANT USED WHEN VERIFYING THE IDENTITY OF YOUR DESIGNATED THIRD PARTY. CHECK ONLY ***ONE*** SECURITY QUESTION BOX IN ITEM 14A AND PROVIDE THE ANSWER IN ITEM 14B.

A. SECURITY QUESTION	B. ANSWER
☐ The city and state your mother was born in	
☐ The name of the high school you attended	
☐ Your first pet's name	
☐ Your favorite teacher's name	
☐ Your father's middle name	

SECTION IV - DECLARATION OF INTENT

I CERTIFY THAT the statements on this form are true and correct to the best of my knowledge and belief.

15. VETERAN/BENEFICIARY/CLAIMANT'S SIGNATURE *(REQUIRED)*	16. DATE SIGNED *(MM/DD/YYYY)* ☐☐ – ☐☐ – ☐☐☐☐

PRIVACY ACT INFORMATION: VA will not disclose information collected on this form to any source other than what has been authorized under the Privacy Act of 1974 or title 38, Code of Federal Regulations 1.576 for routine uses (i.e., civil or criminal law enforcement, congressional communications, epidemiological or research studies, the collection of money owed to the United States, litigation in which the United States is a party or has an interest, the administration of VA programs and delivery of VA benefits, verification of identity and status, and personnel administration as identified in the VA system of records, 58VA21/22/28 Compensation, Pension, Education, and Veteran Readiness and Employment Records - VA, published in the Federal Register. Your obligation to respond is voluntary. VA uses your SSN to identify your claim file. Providing your SSN will help ensure that your records are properly associated with your claim file. Giving us your SSN account information is voluntary. Refusal to provide your SSN by itself will not result in the denial of benefits. The VA will not deny an individual benefits for refusing to provide his or her SSN unless the disclosure of the SSN is required by Federal Statute of law in effect prior to January 1, 1975, and still in effect.

RESPONDENT BURDEN: An agency may not conduct or sponsor, and a person is not required to respond to, a collection of information unless it displays a currently valid OMB control number. The OMB control number for this project is 2900-0736, and it expires 05/31/2029. Public reporting burden for this collection of information is estimated to average 5 minutes per respondent, per year, including the time for reviewing instructions, searching existing data sources, gathering and maintaining the data needed, and completing and reviewing the collection of information. Send comments regarding this burden estimate and any other aspect of this collection of information, including suggestions for reducing the burden, to VA Reports Clearance Officer at vapra@va.gov. Please refer to OMB Control No. 2900-0736 in any correspondence. Do not send your completed VA Form 21-0845 to this email address.